

Hey Ankit, great speaking with you today. Your point about not wanting to go from 14 LPA at TCS to 16 LPA at another service company stuck with me -- that is exactly the right way to frame this decision.

Your questions answered

1 Coursera is free. So what are you actually paying Rs.3.5L for?

Andrew Ng's content is genuinely good -- no argument there. But you have been at TCS for 4 years and you already know what self-paced learning without accountability looks like in practice. What Scaler is built around is **live classes 3x a week with industry instructors**, 1:1 mentorship with people currently working at product companies, and **50+ hands-on projects** -- not watched videos. The other thing Coursera cannot give you is a structured path into hiring: **900+ hiring partners** and a 100,000+ alumni network that includes people who made exactly the switch you are describing. The Rs.3.5L is not for the content -- it is for the structure, the accountability, and the door it opens.

2 Will this actually move the needle on salary, or is it a lateral shift?

You were clear: if the outcome is 16 LPA at another service company, the math does not work, and you are right. I will not quote you a personal number because your outcome depends on your effort, the roles you target, and the market -- and anyone who gives you a guaranteed figure on a sales call is making it up. What I can tell you is that Scaler publishes a **median salary hike of around 110% for the DS/ML track**. For benchmarks specific to a 4 YoE SDE-2 with your AWS cert moving into AI engineering at a product company, that is a conversation worth having in detail on your next call with admissions -- with real alumni data, not a ballpark.

3 RAG, agents, evals -- is this actually in the program, or is it theoretical ML?

This is the right question to push on, and the answer is yes -- the curriculum explicitly includes **Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration** as part of the AI and Agents module, plus an Agentic AI elective. This is not a statistics-and-sklearn program dressed up with AI branding. Your AWS background and 4 years of backend work at HDFC and Citi-scale systems actually puts you in a strong position to go deep on the applied engineering side of these topics, not just the theory. Exact project briefs and what shipped in the current cohort are worth confirming with admissions so you know precisely what you will build.

4 You said you keep wondering if you are already too late. You are not.

4 years of production engineering on banking systems, an AWS Solutions Architect cert, and a CSE degree from VIT -- that is not a weak starting point for an AI engineering pivot, it is actually a strong one. The engineers getting hired into product AI roles right now are not fresh grads who watched Coursera; they are people who can build reliable systems and

layer AI on top. The entrance test is the first concrete step -- it is what gates your second call and gets the enrollment process moving. Take it, and let the next conversation be about specifics.

TODAY Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.	TARGET PATH Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.
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NOW Skills audit & entrance clarity	0-4 MO Core foundations & habits	4-8 MO Depth projects & design	8-12 MO Interview readiness
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Take the entrance test when you are ready -- it is the one thing that unlocks the next conversation and gets you actual cohort and outcome data for your profile.